
Component 2: Child Language

Overview

In this component, students will explore and critically evaluate the development of both speech and writing in children between the ages of 0 and 8. Students will focus on the spoken language acquisition of children and will explore how children learn to write.

Learning outcomes

Students are required to appropriately and systematically:

- analyse and evaluate examples of children's language using a descriptive approach
- apply and evaluate relevant theories associated with the development of spoken and written language
- analyse and evaluate how language development is influenced by the function and context of the language used.

Content

Students will understand the ways in which speech develops and the relationship between spoken language acquisition and the literacy skills children are taught, including the beginnings of reading and learning to write. Students will analyse both written and spoken data, demonstrating critical understanding of relevant children's language development theories.

Throughout this component, students will explore the following aspects of children's spoken language acquisition:

- the beginnings of speech
- the acquisition and development of the sound system (**phonetics**)
- how children understand the structure of words (**morphology**)
- the development and extension of vocabulary (**lexis**)
- how children understand the meanings of words (**semantics**)
- the types of structures used by children at various stages of development and how children start to form larger structures (**syntax**)
- the way children talk to adults and the way adults talk to children; the development of interactive and pragmatic skills (**conversation**).

Students will also explore the following aspects of children's written language development:

- the transition from speech to writing: the use of drawing, gesture and writing to create meaning

- the development of letter forms, capital letters, linearity and directionality; the link between letters, sounds and early spelling (**graphology**)
- the effect of learnt reading strategies on spelling (**morphology**)
- the vocabulary choices (**lexis**) and sentence structures (**syntax**) in early writing
- the development of narrative and descriptive skills (**discourse**).

Please ensure that students are familiar with the English phonemic reference sheet in *Appendix 5* and the transcription mark key in *Appendix 6*. The reference sheet and the mark key will be given to students in the examination.

Component 3: Investigating Language

Overview

In this component, students will have the opportunity to develop their research and investigation skills. They will consolidate their knowledge of language frameworks and key language concepts gained from components 1, 2 and the non-examination assessment.

Students will apply these skills to an area of language study that particularly interests them, selected from pre-released subtopics, in preparation for an externally assessed examination.

This component is skills based, with the content being driven by individual students' interests. Teachers must ensure that students are taught research and investigation skills and introduced to the relevant language topic areas.

Learning outcomes

Students are required to appropriately and systematically:

- apply critical skills in description, analysis and evaluation of a range of data and discourses
- use and apply linguistic terminology accurately
- undertake independent investigations of language, selecting appropriate methods and techniques
- critically evaluate attitudes towards language and its users, making connections with their investigation
- synthesise and reflect on language knowledge drawn from different areas of their studies of English language.

Content

Students' investigation skills are developed in the context of one of the following five topic areas:

- Global English
- Language and Gender Identity
- Language and Journalism
- Language and Power
- Regional Language Variation.

Pre-release

On 1 December before the examination, a subtopic will be **pre-released** on our website (www.edexcel.com) for each of the five topic areas *. The **five pre-released** subtopics will provide a steer for students' research and investigation and will include:

- an introduction to the subtopic, for example the subtopic for 'Global English' in our Sample Assessment Materials is 'South African English'
- suggested research resources.

The 'suggested resources' are guidance for students and are not definitive. Students can decide which resources to use but they are expected to research and investigate the topic beyond the suggested resources.

The five subtopics for investigation will be different each year.

Centres must ensure that they use the pre-released subtopic appropriate for the examination series their students will be sitting.

**the change to the pre-release materials date will first come into effect for the 2021 paper: the subtopics for this paper will be released on 1 December 2020. All subsequent series of this paper will also have a 1 December pre-release date.*

Research and investigation

For this component, teaching should focus on developing students' research and investigation skills. Students will be able to research their chosen subtopic independently when it is released in the January before the examination.

Students should carry out a focused investigation and ensure that they have researched the following aspects of their chosen subtopic, as appropriate:

- the origins/development
- the main features
- different varieties
- changing attitudes
- the influence of social/historical/cultural factors.

Students will use their research, the observations made in their investigation and the data they gather to inform their response in the examination.

Students **cannot** take any of their research or investigation data carried out as part of the pre-release into the examination.

Topic details

All prescribed subject content is covered in components 1 and 2 and the non-examination assessment. Therefore, when teaching research and investigation skills before the subtopic is pre-released, teachers are welcome to introduce students to all five main topic areas below or focus on one or two.

Global English

This topic will explore aspects of varieties of global English, including those from outside the UK, such as Ireland, the Americas and the Caribbean, the Pacific and Australasia, Africa, South and Southeast Asia.

Language and Gender Identity

This topic will explore social attitudes and how the forms and conventions of written, spoken and multimodal language can construct or reflect gender and sexual identities.

Language and Journalism

This topic will explore the many varieties of print and online journalism. Students will have opportunities to explore the influence of contextual factors, how language is crafted to meet the expectations of different audiences and purposes, and to consider notions of bias, subjectivity and objectivity.

Language and Power

This topic will explore the way language use in society can create and enforce power relationships. Students will explore aspects such as instrumental and influential power, political discourse, discourses in unequal power relationships, persuasion, prestige and politeness.

Regional Language Variation

This topic will explore English that varies regionally within the UK. Students will explore the historical aspects of regional variation, how and why language varies regionally, attitudes to regional variation, and variation within regional varieties.

Synopticity in assessment

In this component, students are required to apply their learning from across the qualification.

In **Section A** students will respond to unseen data from their chosen subtopic.

Students will synthesise and reflect on the language knowledge and understanding drawn from the other components in this qualification and from their research and investigation for this component.

In **Section B** students will respond to an evaluative question on their chosen subtopic.

Students will also analyse data and apply language concepts and methods of analysis to a range of data. They will make connections with their research and the observations from their investigation, critically evaluating attitudes towards language and its users.

Please ensure that students are familiar with the English phonemic reference sheet in *Appendix 5* and the transcription mark key in *Appendix 6*. The reference sheet and the mark key will be given to students in the examination.

Non-examination assessment – Crafting Language

Overview

In the non-examination assessment, students will develop their research skills as they explore their selected writing genre and will demonstrate their skills as writers, crafting texts for different audiences and purposes. They will also reflect on their work in an accompanying commentary, making connections with their research.

Learning outcomes

Students are required to appropriately and systematically:

- demonstrate expertise and creativity in the use of English to communicate in different ways, drawing on their knowledge of the forms and structures of spoken or written English for different audiences and purposes
- select and apply methods of language analysis in order to comment and reflect on their own writing using appropriate terminology and coherent, accurate written expression
- demonstrate critical understanding of concepts and issues relevant to language use, including register and style
- analyse and evaluate how contextual factors and language features are associated with the construction of meaning in stimulus texts and in their own writing
- explore connections between their research and their writing, informed by linguistic concepts
- synthesise and reflect on language knowledge and understanding drawn from different areas of their study of English Language
- critically evaluate language use in their own texts and style models.

Content

Students will produce the following assignments:

- Assignment 1: **two** pieces of original writing from the same genre, differentiated by function and/or audience (1500-2000 words)
- Assignment 2: **one** commentary, reflecting on the two pieces they have produced and making connections with their research (1000 words).

Assignment 1: Original writing

Students will select **one** genre to research for their assignment. They will produce **two** pieces of writing in this genre, differentiated by function and/or audience. Examples of genres they might choose include:

- feature articles
- journalist interviews
- speeches
- scripted presentations
- dramatic monologues
- short stories
- travel writing.

Example 1: a student could choose the genre of 'short stories' and produce the following **two** clearly differentiated texts for Assignment 1:

Genre	Audience	Function	Text description
Short stories	Year 6 students	Entertain	A short story set in a fantasy world.
	Adults	Entertain	A short story set in a dystopian world.

Example 2: a student could choose the genre of 'travel writing' and produce the following **two** clearly differentiated texts for Assignment 1:

Genre	Audience	Function	Text description
Travel writing	Gap year students	Inform	A magazine feature on top travel destinations for your gap year.
	Pensioners	Persuade	A magazine article to encourage pensioners to explore the world.

In preparation for this non-examination assessment, students will explore:

- distinctive features of a variety of genres
- texts that exemplify key features of their chosen genre (**style models**)
- the effect of language choices and discourse strategies for different contexts.

They will also develop:

- the skills of effective and accurate drafting and redrafting.

It is expected that students will undertake research in order to prepare for the writing assignments. While these preparatory stages are not assessed and are not required for submission, students will be expected to make connections between their research and their original writing in their commentary.

Students are encouraged to see their writing as work in progress. They should be prepared to draft and redraft as part of the writing process and to reflect on and critically evaluate this process in their commentary.

Assignment length should be appropriate to the selected genre and function. For example, it is likely that two short stories would require a higher word count than two speeches.

Assignment 2: Commentary

In their commentary, students will reflect on the writing process. They should:

- discuss the findings of their initial research into their chosen genre
- make connections between the techniques used in the **style models** and those they have adopted in their own writing
- evaluate language choices they made, through the drafting process, to achieve effects appropriate to the chosen function and target audience

Students are expected to use a range of terminology accurately and ensure that any texts and other sources used are accurately referenced.

Assignment setting, taking and marking

Assignment setting

When deciding on the assignments they will produce, students should be encouraged to draw on their own interests and skills, as well as applying what they have learned about language. The choice of assignments should be made with teacher guidance to ensure that the assignments are of an appropriate standard.

It is advised that because of the personal nature of assignment selection each year, students complete different assignments from previous years.

Assignment use

Teachers should ensure that assignments chosen by students are relevant and appropriate to the student's course of learning. Students should have the opportunity to choose sources/interpretations/texts as appropriate.

Assignment research

Teaching and learning

Teachers should provide students with a short course of study that covers:

- research and study skills
- editing and proofreading skills
- referencing and bibliography skills.

Collaboration

Students may work together on their research.

Feedback

Teachers may help students to understand rubrics, assessment criteria and controls. Teachers must not provide students with solutions. For example, teachers may provide a simplified student friendly version of the assessment criteria, but this must not be specific to the work of individual students or a group of students (see the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk). Any additional feedback must be recorded in the *Non-examination Assessment Authentication Sheet* (see *Appendix 4*).

Resources

Students must have equal access to IT resources. Students should have access to a range of resources/texts to enable them to make choices as required for their assignments.

Assignment writing

Authenticity

Students and teachers must sign the *Non-examination Assessment Authentication Sheet* (see *Appendix 4*).

Teachers must review at least one draft to offer support and to ensure they can verify that the student's final work is their own. This support may take the form of **general** advice only and work may not be provisionally assessed. Please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* on the JCQ website (www.jcq.org.uk) for further information on the level of feedback permitted.

Students must ensure that all quotations and citations are referenced using an established referencing system, such as Harvard, and produce a bibliography citing reference texts.

Collaboration

Students must not work with others when writing their assignments. Centres must ensure that the same teacher has reviewed all work from a class in order to be able to verify on the *Non-examination Assessment Authentication Sheet* that students' work is their own.

Feedback

Teachers may help students to understand rubrics, assessment criteria and controls. Any additional feedback must be recorded on the *Non-examination Assessment Authentication Sheet* (see *Appendix 4*). Please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk for further information.

Word count

It is strongly recommended that students write between 1500–2000 words for the original writing and 1000 words for the commentary. The advisory total word count for the non-examination assessment is between 2500–3000 words. This does not include footnotes and bibliographies.

It is advisable that the upper word limit is adhered to by students to enable them to satisfy the requirement to produce a concise and coherently structured response.

Assignment marking

Teachers should mark the assignments using the assessment criteria on the following pages. Teachers may annotate students' work. The marks awarded should be justified and teachers should add comments to the *Non-examination Assessment Authentication Sheet* (see *Appendix 4*).

Assessment criteria

Teachers must mark students' work using the assessment criteria on *pages 20–22*.

Marking guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Teachers must mark the last candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the first.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than be penalised for omissions.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Teachers should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Teachers should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.

The marking grids have been designed to assess student work holistically. The grids identify which Assessment Objective is being targeted by each bullet point within the level descriptors. Each bullet point is linked to one Assessment Objective, however please note that the number of bullet points in the level descriptors does not directly correlate to the number of marks in the level descriptor.

When deciding how to reward an answer using a levels-based mark scheme, the 'best fit' approach should be used. To do this teachers should:

- first decide which level descriptor most closely matches the candidate answer and place it in that band
- decide on the mark awarded within the band based on quality of the answer and modify according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level
- remember that in cases of uneven performance, all the above points still apply. Candidates are to be placed in the band that best describes their answer according to each of the Assessment Objectives described in the level. Marks are to be awarded towards the top or bottom of that band depending how they have evidenced each of the descriptor bullet points
- remember that all Assessment Objectives within a level are equally weighted and take this into consideration when making their judgements.

Please refer to the marking guidance on *page 19* when applying this grid.

Level	Mark	Non-examination assessment: Crafting Language – Original Writing
		Descriptor (A05)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–6	Low skill level - Writing has frequent errors and technical lapses. Limited control of genre and mode, with inappropriate style used for audience and function. - Writing is formulaic and predictable.
Level 2	7–12	General/imprecise skills - Writing has some errors and technical lapses. Shows general understanding of genre, mode and the requirements of audience and function. - Writing attempts an individual voice. Makes obvious, though not always successful, attempts at crafting language for effect.
Level 3	13–18	Clear skills - Writing has minor errors and technical lapses. Applies clear understanding of genre, mode and the requirements of audience and function. - Writing has an individual voice, with clear engaging attempts at crafting language.
Level 4	19–24	Controlled skills - Writing is precisely edited and controlled. Demonstrates effective understanding of genre, mode and the requirements of audience and function. - Writing uses an effective individual voice, that crafts an engaging response. Displays a skilful selection of techniques for effect.
Level 5	25–30	Assured skills - Writing is assured, accurate and highly effective. Displays an assured control of genre, mode and the requirements of audience and function. - Writing employs a sophisticated individual voice that differentiates in terms of audience and/or function. Crafts a highly-engaging response, with sophisticated selection of techniques.

Please refer to the marking guidance on *page 19* when applying this grid.

Level	Mark	Non-examination assessment: Crafting Language – Commentary			
		AO1 – bullet point 1	AO2 – bullet point 2	AO3 – bullet point 3	AO4 – bullet point 4
		Descriptor (AO1, AO2, AO3, AO4)			
	0	No rewardable material			
Level 1	1–4	Descriptive - Knowledge of methods is largely unassimilated. Recalls limited range of terminology and makes frequent errors and technical lapses. - Has a descriptive approach with little awareness of concepts and issues. Makes simple comments on how and why language is used in own writing and style models. - Shows limited understanding of contextual factors. Able to show in simple ways how audience and function can affect the construction of meaning in own writing and style models. - Makes limited links between style models and own writing. Shows limited understanding of relevant concepts and methods.			
Level 2	5–8	General understanding - Recalls methods of analysis that show general understanding. Organises and expresses ideas with some clarity, though has lapses in use of terminology. - Shows general understanding of concepts and issues. Able to apply some of this understanding when describing language use in own writing and style models. - Has general understanding of contextual factors. Can explain effect of audience and function on construction of meaning in own writing and style models, though not always securely applied. - Describes general links between style models and own writing. Shows general understanding of relevant concepts and methods.			
Level 3	9–12	Clear relevant application - Applies relevant methods of analysis to texts with clear examples. Ideas are structured logically and expressed with few lapses in clarity and transitioning. Clear use of terminology. - Clear understanding and application of some concepts and issues. Able to explain language use in own writing and style models.			

Level	Mark	Non-examination assessment: Crafting Language – Commentary			
		AO1 – bullet point 1	AO2 – bullet point 2	AO3 – bullet point 3	AO4 – bullet point 4
		Descriptor (AO1, AO2, AO3, AO4)			
Level 4	13–16	Discriminating controlled approach • Applies controlled discussion of methods supported with use of discriminating examples. Controls the structure of response with effective transitions, carefully chosen language and use of terminology. • Discriminating selection and application of a range of concepts and issues. Able to analyse language use in own writing and style models. • Makes inferences about contextual factors. Discriminating approach to explaining how audience and function affect the construction of meaning in own writing and style models. • Discriminating connections made between style models and own writing. Examines in a controlled way links to concepts and methods.			
Level 5	17–20	Critical evaluative approach • Presents critical application of language analysis with sustained examples. Uses sophisticated structure and expression with appropriate register and style, including use of appropriate terminology. • Critical application of a wide range of concepts and issues. Evaluates language use in own writing and style models. • Exhibits a sophisticated awareness of complex contextual factors. Evaluates how contextual factors affect the construction of meaning in own writing and style models. • Evaluates connections made between style models and own writing. Critically examines links to concepts and methods.			

Marking, standardisation and moderation

The assignments are marked by teachers. Where marking for this qualification has been carried out by more than one teacher in a centre, there must be a process of internal standardisation to ensure that there is a consistent application of the assessment criteria.

Marks awarded by the centre will be subject to external moderation by Pearson. Moderation will ensure consistency with national standards and will review assignments to ensure that the assignment-setting rules have been correctly applied by centres. Pearson will notify centres of the students whose responses have been selected for moderation. This sample will take cohort size into account.

If the moderation indicates that centre assessment does not reflect national standards, an adjustment will be made to students' final marks to compensate.

Please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk for further information. The assessment in this qualification will comply with these instructions.

Security and backups

It is the responsibility of the centre to keep the work that students have submitted for assessment secure.

Secure storage is defined as a securely-locked cabinet or cupboard.

Malpractice

Candidate malpractice

Candidate malpractice refers to any act by a candidate that compromises or seeks to compromise the process of assessment or which undermines the integrity of the qualifications or the validity of results/certificates.

Candidate malpractice in controlled assessments discovered before the candidate has signed the declaration of authentication form does not need to be reported to Pearson.

Candidate malpractice found in controlled assessments after the declaration of authenticity has been signed, and in examinations, **must** be reported to Pearson on a *JCQ Form M1* (available at www.jcq.org.uk/exams-office/malpractice). The form should be emailed to candidatemalpractice@pearson.com. Please provide as much information and supporting documentation as possible. Note that the final decision regarding appropriate sanctions lies with Pearson.

Failure to report candidate malpractice constitutes staff or centre malpractice.

Staff/centre malpractice

Staff and centre malpractice includes both deliberate malpractice and maladministration of our qualifications. As with candidate malpractice, staff and centre malpractice is any act that compromises or seeks to compromise the process of assessment or undermines the integrity of the qualifications or the validity of results/certificates.

All cases of suspected staff malpractice and maladministration **must** be reported immediately, before any investigation is undertaken by the centre, to Pearson on a *JCQ Form M2(a)* (available at www.jcq.org.uk/exams-office/malpractice). The form, supporting documentation and as much information as possible should be emailed to pqsmalpractice@pearson.com. Note that the final decision regarding appropriate sanctions lies with Pearson.

Failure to report malpractice itself constitutes malpractice.

More-detailed guidance on malpractice can be found in the latest version of the document *General and Vocational Qualifications Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments Policies and Procedures*, available at www.jcq.org.uk/exams-office/malpractice.

Further information

For up-to-date advice on teacher involvement and administration of non-examination assessments, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk

Assessment

Assessment summary

Summary of table of assessment

It is expected that students use a range of terminology accurately in the examination and make accurate reference to texts and data.

Centres are reminded that the marks given are raw marks and as such for results purposes will be scaled to reflect the appropriate component weighting.

Students must complete all assessment in May/June in any single year.